



Tampa Bay Times

Tampa Bay Times Media Briefing Sheet

Chipotle Partnering with the Red Cross to Donate Food to Hurricane Milton Victims

ABOUT THE OPPORTUNITY

Logistics:

- **Interview Date & Time:** Nov. 10, 2024, at 9:30 a.m. ET
 - **ARRIVAL TIME: 8:45 a.m. ET**
- **Interview Duration:** 25 minutes
- **Interviewer:** Helen Freund
- **Interviewees:** Scott Boatwright, interim CEO of Chipotle Mexican Grill

About Tampa Bay Times:

The Tampa Bay Times is a for-profit news organization that covers all topics of interest from state and local politics to technology, sports, finance and food in the Tampa Bay area. It has won 14 Pulitzer Prizes and has the largest investigative reporting team in Florida. The newspaper is owned by the nonprofit the Poynter Institute. Its newspapers are available to read in print in stores and on newsstands across the Tampa Bay area and are available online.

Example Headline Stories:

- [Tampa Bay Times: These Tampa Bay bars and restaurants are open after Hurricane Milton](#)
- [Tampa Bay Times: FEMA offered free hotel stays to displaced residents](#)
- [Tampa Bay Times: Displaced Rays secure interim office space, pitch in to help the community](#)
- [Tampa Bay Times: Floridians impacted by Milton, Helene can soon get help replacing food](#)



About Helen Freund (she/her):

Freund is a reporter for the Tampa Bay Times who specializes in food, dining and industry. Before joining the Times, Freund was the dining editor at the Gambit Weekly in New Orleans. She studied journalism at the University of Washington and culinary arts at Le Cordon Bleu in Paris.



About the Interview:

The duration and aftermath of Hurricane Milton have been covered by the Tampa Bay Times from start to finish. After Chipotle announced its collaboration with the Red Cross to help those affected by the storm, the Times is interested in getting a deeper scope on why the decision was made, how both organizations will be executing this process and what benefits they would hope to see from it. We encourage you to be authentic in your responses and, when appropriate, tie in Chipotle's dedication to the public good and the brand's awareness of societal problems. The interview will be recorded for the reporter to be able to go back and listen.

DAY-OF LOGISTICS

Location & Getting There:

- Location: Tampa Bay Time Headquarters, 490 First Avenue South, St. Petersburg, Florida,
 - Freund and the Managing Editor Michael Van Sickler will meet you in the station's conference room at 9 a.m. ET to get settled and prepare for the interview.
 - When you arrive at the station, you will check in with the building's security by giving them your name and a form of identification. They will then direct you to the conference room. The full list of attendees for the interview with the Times' team is below:
 - Interim CEO of Chipotle Mexican Grill Scott Boatwright (Interviewee)
 - Managing Editor/News Michael Van Sickler
 - Reporter Helen Freund

Day-of Contact:

Interim CEO of Chipotle Mexican Grill Scott Boatwright

687-987-9904

tbenson@chipotle.com

What to Wear:

Typically, when people go to headquarters to interview, they are wearing a business-casual outfit and sport a company-branded shirt or polo. Do not wear anything that is too flashy or outlandish, and stick to a more neutral color palette to keep the focus on the interview. We recommend wearing a black polo with the Chipotle logo, black business pants, business shoes and any accessories that fit (a watch, belt, etc.).

Products to Bring:

- A business card for the reporter in case they need to contact someone after the interview.
- The written directions that were made on how to get to the interview.
- A form of identification for security. A driver's license will work.

KEY MESSAGES AND TALKING POINTS

Anticipated Topics of Discussion:



- What initial factors went into deciding to start this campaign to help people who were affected?
- Logistics of the campaign and how it will be running
- Chipotle's brand awareness and mission to aid the general public
- How people can get involved and aid the campaign
- How did Chipotle decide to partner with the Red Cross? This is going to be an early topic.

Tips to Consider:

- More than 12,647 people lost their homes in the Tampa Bay area due to Hurricane Milton.
- Chipotle decided to run the campaign in Tampa because the issue is extremely severe there, and the company has the resources to support the size of the damage..
- The dates that the campaign will be running are from Monday, Nov. 11, to Monday, Nov. 18, 2024. The times each day will be from 11 a.m. to 11 p.m.
- There are 11 locations that will be running the campaign in Tampa, FL.
 - Chipotle Carrollwood
 - Chipotle New Tampa Highwoods Preserve
 - Chipotle Dale Mabry & Walnut
 - Chipotle International Plaza Food Court
 - Chipotle USF Fowler 2
 - Chipotle Westshore
 - Chipotle Dale Mabry & Gandy
 - Chipotle South Tampa
 - Chipotle Gunn Highway Citrus Park
 - Chipotle Dale Mabry & Waters
 - Chipotle Westchase
- The menu items being offered will be served out of trays, and all the food will be served warm. Chipotle's iconic white and brown rice will be served alongside all toppings, red and green salsa, every source of protein on the menu and given in the form of bowls. To conserve time, there will be no burritos or tacos being made at every station.
- Chipotle approached the Red Cross first when going to make this arrangement because the company realized it would need more support to roll out this plan. Both executive teams have been working together to make this happen.
- To receive food, victims would need to sign up prior through the Red Cross's website, all they would need to provide is their home address and the number of people in their family who will be attending with them.
- There is going to be a form to sign up to be a volunteer on the Red Cross's website as well, that anyone 16 years old and up can apply to. After applying, within 48 hours a representative will reach out to give more information.



TOUGH Q&A

Given the circumstances around the situation are still very prominent and people are in a great amount of distress, we are encouraging you to be ready to answer any potential questions relating to the status of the situation and how Chipotle will be helping. To ensure you have the details to properly respond, below are some sample questions and answers for your reference.

Potential Questions & Recommended Responses:

- People who are going through tough times can be hesitant to reach out for help or don't know how to find it. How is Chipotle ensuring that they are reaching out to those affected respectfully?
 - We understand that reaching out to those affected by Hurricane Milton requires sensitivity and care. The Red Cross, which has experience in disaster relief, is aiding us to make sure that our outreach efforts are truly responsive to the needs of Tampa's residents. We are making sure all members of our communication team are spreading the word and making this information easily accessible so there are the least amount of complications possible and doing so in a way that respects people's privacy and unique needs during these tough times.
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- Chipotle has a strong brand image, but some critics might say that your joint campaign with the Red Cross to support Hurricane Milton victims is more about public relations than real impact. How do you respond to concerns that this campaign is more about brand visibility than genuine assistance?
 - We recognize that any time a brand engages in charitable efforts, there's the potential for skepticism about motivations. However, this partnership with the Red Cross is about making a real impact, not just raising our profile. We chose to get involved because we have the resources and the reach to make a difference. Our commitment goes beyond just financial support. We're actively involved in logistics, working to ensure that food and clean water reach affected communities as quickly and efficiently as possible. Ultimately, the impact we're aiming to achieve — helping people rebuild their lives after Hurricane Milton — speaks louder than any campaign or brand recognition ever could.

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